

100 Days of Linux - Day 071

Title: Networking Basics - ping Command

Today's Goal

Learn how to test whether another computer or website is reachable using the ping command.

Why This Matters

Network connectivity testing is one of the first troubleshooting steps used by Linux administrators, developers, DevOps engineers, and data engineers.

Command of the Day

ping

Syntax: ping <host>

Common options: -c (count), -4 (IPv4), -6 (IPv6).

Examples:

```
ping google.com
```

```
ping -c 4 google.com
```

Beginner Lesson

The ping command sends small network packets to another computer or website and waits for a reply. If replies are received, the connection is working. Press Ctrl+C to stop a continuous ping.

Practice Questions

1. Ping google.com.
2. Send only 4 ping requests to google.com.
3. Ping github.com.
4. Ping localhost.
5. Compare responses from localhost and google.com.

Hints

Use -c to limit requests. Ensure you are connected to the internet.

Mini Challenge

Test three different websites using ping -c 3 and note which respond fastest.

Common Mistakes

Misspelling the hostname, forgetting Ctrl+C, or assuming every website allows ping.

Did You Know?

Some servers block ICMP ping requests for security reasons.

Pro Tip

Always verify basic connectivity with ping before deeper network troubleshooting.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: ping google.com

Q2: ping -c 4 google.com

Q3: ping github.com

Q4: ping localhost

Q5: Run both commands and compare response times.

Homework

Ping five different websites and record their average response times.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn how to download web content using the curl command.